

SUTIRTHA BAGCHI

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS HELD

Associate Professor of Economics	Fall 2021 – Present
Diana and James Yacobucci '73 Assistant Professor of Economics	Fall 2017 – Spring 2021
Assistant Professor of Economics, Villanova University	Fall 2014 – Spring 2017

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Business Economics, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor	August 2014
M.A., Economics, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor	May 2013
MBA, Krannert School of Management, Purdue University	May 2006
B. Tech., Chemical Engineering, Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur	May 2002

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS (* denotes student co-author)

1. “The Effects of Introducing Withholding on Tax Compliance: Evidence from Pennsylvania’s Local Earned Income Tax”, *National Tax Journal*, June 2025, 78(2), 327–367.
2. “Wealth Inequality and Democracy,” with Matthew Fagerstrom(*), *Public Choice*, October 2023, 197(1-2), 89–136.
3. “Withholding Matters: The Effect of Act 32 on Pennsylvania’s Earned Income Tax Collections”, *Economics Letters*, October 2022, 219, Article Number: 110796.
4. “Third-party Reporting and Tax Collections: Evidence from the Introduction of Withholding of the State Personal Income Tax,” with Libor Dušek, *Journal of Public Economics*, December 2021, 204, Article Number: 104537.
5. “The Effects of Political Competition on the Funding of Public-Sector Pension Plans,” *Financial Management*, Fall 2021, 50(3), 691–725 (Recognized as the 2nd Best Paper in the Fall issue).
6. “Does the Strength of Incentives Matter for Elected Officials? A Look at Tax Collectors,” *The B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis & Policy*, 2021, 21(3), 967–1012.
7. “Public-Sector Pension Plans and the Discount Rate Assumption: The Role of Political Incentives,” with James Naughton, *Economics Letters*, July 2021, 204, Article Number: 109914.
8. “Can Entrepreneurial Initiative Blunt the Economic Inequality– Growth Curse? Evidence From 92 Countries,” with Pankaj C. Patel and Jonathan Doh, *Business & Society*, 2021, 60(2), 496–541.
9. “Monetary Growth and Wealth Inequality,” with Michael Patrick Curran and Matthew Fagerstrom(*), *Economics Letters*, September 2019, 182, 23–25.
10. “The Effects of Political Competition on the Generosity of Public-Sector Pension Plans,” *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, August 2019, 164, 439–468.
11. “A Tale of Two Cities: An Examination of Medallion Prices in New York and Chicago,” *Review of Industrial Organization*, September 2018, 53(2), 295–319.

12. “Barriers to Entry and Competitive Behavior: Evidence from Reforms of Cable Franchising Regulations,” with Jagadeesh Sivadasan, *Journal of Industrial Economics*, September 2017, 65(3), 510–558.
13. “The Political Economy of Tax Enforcement: A Look at the IRS from 1978–2010,” *Journal of Public Policy*, September 2016, 36(3), 335–380.
14. “Does Wealth Inequality Matter for Growth? The Effect of Billionaire Wealth, Income Distribution, and Poverty,” with Jan Svejnar, *Journal of Comparative Economics*, August 2015, 43(3), 505–530. Media mentions: Forbes, The Guardian, and The Washington Post.

WORKING PAPERS (* denotes student co-author)

1. “Tax Withholding and the Size of Government,” with Libor Dušek
2. “The Impact of Ending Mandatory Union Fees: Evidence from Administrative Data” (Submitted)
3. “The Workforce Consequences of Ending Mandatory Union Fees: Evidence from *Janus v. AF-SCME*”
4. “Visible Inequality and Voter Support for Public Goods: Evidence from Ohio School Finance Referenda,” with Camryn Browne(*) and Corey Lang (Submitted)

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

1. “Is $r > g$: An attempt at Answering a Vexing Question Using a Panel Dataset on Global Billionaire Wealth”
2. “Patterns and Trends in Global Wealth Inequality: A Look at Billionaires from 1987–2017”
3. “The Declining Importance of Inherited Wealth at the Top of the Wealth Distribution: An Examination Using the Forbes Four Hundred”
4. “The Effects of Varying Partisan and Gender Composition of School Boards on School Budgets”

NON PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

1. “Billionaires & Democracy”, January 2024, *Milken Institute Review*.
2. “Wealth Inequality and Democracy”, with Matthew Fagerstrom, *Research Briefs in Economic Policy*, 2023, 352, Cato Institute.
3. “Does Wealth Distribution and the Source of Wealth Matter for Economic Growth? Inherited v. Uninherited Billionaire Wealth and Billionaires’ Political Connections,” with Jan Svejnar, In Kaushik Basu and Joseph Stiglitz (eds.) *Inequality and Growth: Patterns and Policy*, 2016.
4. “Billionaires and Growth,” with Jan Svejnar, January 2016, *Milken Institute Review*.
5. “Does Wealth Inequality Matter for Growth? The Effect of Billionaire Wealth, Income Distribution, and Poverty,” with Jan Svejnar, *Research Briefs in Economic Policy*, 2015, Cato Institute.

6. “Promise now, pay later,” *Pensions & Investments*, December 22, 2014.
7. “The real reason why politicians talk about pensions but don’t fix them? Money,” *The Patriot-News*, November 2, 2014.

PRESENTATIONS (LAST 6 YEARS ONLY)

2026: American Economic Association and Swarthmore College.
 2025: National Tax Association and University of Michigan Tax Invitational (M-TAXI).
 2024: National Tax Association and University of Utah UPFIN conference.
 2023: National Tax Association and University of Michigan Tax Invitational (M-TAXI).

HONORS AND AWARDS

The McDonough Family Faculty Award for Research Excellence	May 2023
Villanova School of Business’s Faculty-Student Collaboration Award	May 2022
Lincoln Scholar, Lincoln Institute of Land Policy	May 2017
Krannert Scholar, Top 5% of graduating class	May 2006
B.C. Roy Silver Medal for valedictorian in Department of Chemical Engineering	May 2002

GRANTS

Summer Research Grant (Villanova University)	Summer 2018, 2021, 2024, and 2026
Grant for Freshman Match Program (Villanova University)	Spring 2016 and 2024

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Introduction to Microeconomics, Micro-Economic Theory, and Public Economics (Villanova Univ.)

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder & Owner, Law & Economics Consulting LLC	October 2023–Present
Associate, McKinsey & Company (Pittsburgh Office)	July 2006–August 2008
Technical Services Manager, Unilever India	July 2002–April 2004

SERVICE

External:

Profession: Book Editor, *Public Budgeting & Finance* (June 2025–Present); Member of the Scientific Committee, Annual Congress of the International Institute of Public Finance (Fall 2025–Present)

Referee: *Applied Economics*; *Applied Economics Letters*; *Contemporary Economic Policy*; *Eastern Economic Journal*; *Economic Modelling*; *Economic Systems*; *Economics Bulletin*; *Economics of Transition*; *Empirical Economics*; *Industrial Relations: A Journal of Economy and Society*; *International Tax and Public Finance*; *Journal of Comparative Economics*; *Journal of Economic Growth*; *Journal of Economics & Management Strategy*; *Journal of Industry, Competition and Trade*; *Journal of Information Policy*;

Journal of Public Economics; Journal of Public Policy; Policy & Politics; Political Research Quarterly; Public Choice; Public Finance Review; Review of Income and Wealth; Review of Industrial Organization; The Financial Review; and The Review of Economics and Statistics.

Internal:

University: Villanova Institute for Teaching & Learning (VITAL) Faculty Mentor (2025–Present); Member, University Awards Committee (2025–2026); Member, Faculty Congress (2024–Present); Member, Faculty Rights and Responsibilities Committee (2026–Present); Member, Academic Policy Committee (2024–2026); Member, Small Research Grant Evaluation Committee (2021 & 2022); Volunteer, Academic Integrity Panel (2019 & 2023); and Faculty panelist, New Faculty Program, VITAL (2015).

College: Member, VSB Research Committee (2021–Present); Member, Transition to Tenure committee (2022–Present); Member, Teaching and Learning Committee (2019–2022), Faculty and Staff Development Committee (2019–2020); Faculty Support, Mentoring, and Recognition Committee (2017–2018); and Exploration Task Force for a Doctoral Program (2016–2017).

Department: Organizer, Lucia Lecture (2016–Present); Member, Hiring Committee (2024–2025 cycle; 2025–2026 cycle); Member, Department Rank & Tenure Committee (2021–Present).